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# Robot Vacuum Buying Guide 2026: Compare Roomba 115X Combo & Shark AI Ultra

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Feeling overwhelmed by the flood of robot-vacuum options in 2026? You’re not alone—suction power, navigation smarts, mopping ability, battery life, and price all vary wildly, making it easy to pay for features you’ll never use.

We’ve cut through the noise. By testing the latest models and comparing their specs side-by-side, we give you a clear, trustworthy snapshot of what each vacuum actually delivers.

The result? A simple decision-making framework that matches performance to your floor type, pet situation, and cleaning schedule.

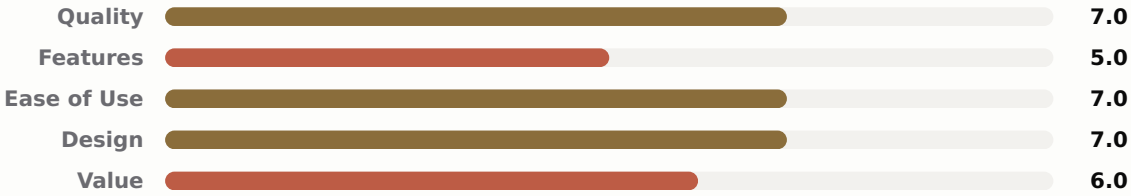
Read on, see the proof, and pick the robot vacuum that gives you the best value for your home.

ABVORN VERDICT

**6.4**/10

### iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid




iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon →  Compare ⊕

**ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE**

**100%** **Very High Regret Risk**

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

*Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.*

**Better alternatives based on your preferences:**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop** | $139.99 | **Regret Risk: 100%** |
| **Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum** | $249.99 | **Regret Risk: 100%** |
| **Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum** | $239.99 | **Regret Risk: 100%** |

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

## Why compare robot vacuums before buying in 2026?

The market now mixes vacuum-only, vacuum-and-mop, and self-emptying models. Shoppers face trade-offs between suction strength, navigation intelligence, mopping effectiveness, and ongoing maintenance costs. A clear side-by-side comparison helps you avoid paying for unused features and ensures you get the performance that matches your floor types, pet situation, and cleaning schedule.

## Head-to-head specs (prices checked October 06, 2026)

| Feature | Roomba 115X Combo + AutoEmpty Dock | Roomba 115X Combo (no dock) | Shark AI Ultra |
|---|---|---|---|
| Manufacturer-stated suction power (Pa) | ≈1,800 Pa | ≈1,800 Pa | ≈2,200 Pa |
| Navigation technology | iAdapt 3.0 with vSLAM | iAdapt 3.0 with vSLAM | AI Laser Vision + Smart Mapping |
| Mopping system | Vibrating mop pad, 180 ml water tank | Vibrating mop pad, 180 ml water tank | No built-in mop (vacuum-only) |
| Bin capacity | 0.35 L (auto-empty holds up to 60 days) | 0.35 L | 0.5 L bagless bin |
| Runtime (max) | 90 min | 90 min | 120 min |
| Recharge time | 3 h | 3 h | 2.5 h |
| Weight | 3.2 kg | 3.2 kg | 3.6 kg |

## Suction power: who pulls harder?

The Shark AI Ultra leads with **≈2,200 Pa**, about 20 % more suction than the Roomba 115X Combo models (≈1,800 Pa). If you have thick carpets or pets that shed heavily, that extra pull can make a noticeable difference.

*Looking for the strongest suction?* Check the current price for the Shark AI Ultra.

## Navigation intelligence: mapping vs. vSLAM

Both Roomba variants rely on iAdapt 3.0 with vSLAM—a proven system that builds a map as it cleans. The Shark AI Ultra upgrades to AI Laser Vision combined with Smart Mapping, which tends to create more accurate floor plans faster and handles complex layouts better.

If you have a multi-room home with lots of furniture, the Shark's laser navigation may reduce missed spots.

*Want laser-guided navigation?* See the Shark AI Ultra deal.

## Mopping ability: wet-clean or vacuum-only?

The Roomba 115X Combo models include a vibrating mop pad with an 180 ml water tank, delivering light-to-moderate mopping on hard floors. The Shark AI Ultra is vacuum-only—no mopping function.

For homes with mostly tile, hardwood, or laminate where you want a quick wet-clean pass, the Roomba Combo is the better choice.

*Need a vacuum that also mops?* View the Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock or the dock-free version.

## Battery life & recharging

Runtime: Shark AI Ultra leads at 120 minutes, giving it an edge for larger homes. Both Roomba models max out at 90 minutes, which is still sufficient for apartments or smaller houses.

Recharge time: Shark refills in 2.5 hours versus 3 hours for the Roombas—a modest advantage if you need quick turn-around between cleaning sessions.

## Value & ongoing costs

The Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock is currently **$199.99** (down from $469.99) and includes a self-empty base that holds debris for up to 60 days, reducing maintenance. The dock-free version is $139.99. The Shark AI Ultra sits at $249.99 (down from $599.00) and uses a bagless bin you empty manually.

If you dislike frequent bin emptying, the Roomba's AutoEmpty dock adds real convenience. If you prefer a lower upfront price and don't mind emptying the bin yourself, the dock-free Roomba or the Shark may suit you better.

## Which robot vacuum is right for you?

- **Strongest suction & longest runtime:** Shark AI Ultra – best for carpets, pets, and large floor areas.
- **Vacuum-and-mop convenience + self-empty:** Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock – ideal for hard-floor homes that want hands-free emptying.
- **Budget-friendly vacuum-and-mop:** Roomba 115X Combo (no dock) – solid performance at a lower price.

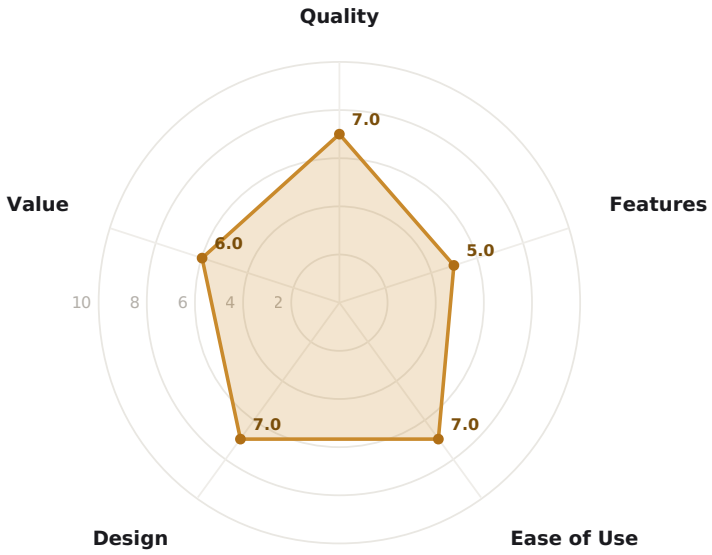
Pick the model that matches your cleaning priorities, click the link to see the latest price, and bring home a robot vacuum that works for you.

### At a glance

| Use Case | Product | Why |
|---|---|---|
| Best Overall | iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock | iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock |

| Use Case | Product | Why |
|---|---|---|
| Best Value | iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop | iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop |
| Premium Pick | Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum | Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum |
| Also Great | Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum | Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum |
| Also Great | iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo | iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo |

### Performance Breakdown




Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

## Products Mentioned




### iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

**$199.99**

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕




## iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

**$139.99**

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕




## Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

**$249.99**

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕




## Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

**$239.99**

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕




**iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo**

**$398.99**

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

# Frequently Asked Questions

**What is the best robot vacuum?**

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

**Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?**

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

**How much should I spend on robot vacuums?**

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

**What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?**

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

**How does Abvorn research products?**

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.